Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Bb Cc

The Letters B and C

Now we start the consonants. B has one sound. C has two.

Consonants · 2 letters

Bb The Letter B one sound

1 The sound of B

/b/
Close your lips, then open them

bell band cab

2 When is B silent?

B is almost never silent on its own.

3 B with other letters

bb — /b/ rabbit hobby ribbon
Two same letters together make one sound.

ALWAYS

The Letters B and C (continued)

Cc The Letter C two sounds — hard and soft

4 The sounds of C

/k/ Hard C	/s/ Soft C
camp	city
color	center
copy	cell

Before E or I, C says /s/.
Before other letters, C says /k/.

● ALMOST ALWAYS

5 When is C silent?

C is almost never silent on its own.

6 C with other letters

cc	/k/	soccer	account	occur
	/ks/	accept	success	accent

Before E or I, CC says /ks/.

● USUALLY TRUE

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Dd Ff

The Letters D and F

D and F have one sound each. D also helps us read the past.

Consonants · 2 letters

Dd The Letter D one sound

1 The sound of D

/d/
Tongue behind your top teeth

desk dog red

2 When is D silent?

D is silent in a few words.

Wednesday
Grey letter = silent

● NOT A RULE — A FEW WORDS

3 D with other letters

ed

/t/ jumped helped washed
/d/ played opened called
/ɪd/ wanted needed ended

At the end of a word. After T or D, ED says /ɪd/.

● ALWAYS

The Letters D and F (continued)

Ff The Letter F one sound

4 The sound of F

/f/
Top teeth on your bottom lip

fan gift soft

One very common word is different.

of

● NOT A RULE — A FEW WORDS

In of, F says /v/.

5 When is F silent?

F is almost never silent.

6 F with other letters

ff	/f/	off	coffee	staff	● ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z



The Letter G

G is a consonant. Like C, it has a hard sound and a soft sound.

Consonant · 2 sounds

1 The sounds of G

/g/
Hard G

gas
gold
flag

/dʒ/
Soft G

giant
magic
agent

Before E or I, G often says /dʒ/.

● NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD

Many words are different:
get · give · gift

2 When is G silent?

G is almost never silent on its own.

The Letter G (continued)

3 G with other letters

gu /g/ guess guide guitar
The U is silent.
● USUALLY TRUE

dge /dʒ/ edge badge bridge
● ALWAYS

gg /g/ bigger foggy luggage
● ALMOST ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z



The Letter H

H is a consonant. It is just a breath — and it makes new sounds with other letters.

Consonant · 1 sound

1 The sound of H

/h/
A soft breath out

hat hand help

2 When is H silent?

H is silent at the start of a few words.

hour honest herb

Grey letter = silent

● NOT A RULE — A FEW WORDS

3 H with other letters

ch

/tʃ/ chip lunch much
/k/ school echo
/ʃ/ chef machine

Most words say /tʃ/.

● NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD

igh

/aɪ/ high light night

The GH is silent.

● ALWAYS

gh

SILENT eight weight caught
/f/ laugh

● NOT FIXED — LEARN EACH WORD

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Jj Kk

The Letters J and K

J and K have one sound each.

Consonants · 2 letters

Jj The Letter J one sound

1 The sound of J

/dʒ/
Like soft G

job jam jump

2 When is J silent?

J is never silent.

Kk The Letter K one sound

3 The sound of K

/k/
Like hard C

kid kit keep

4 When is K silent?

K is silent in some words. You will learn them with the letter N.

5 K with other letters

ck

/k/ back duck sick

CK comes after a short vowel.

ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Ll Mm

The Letters L and M

L and M have one sound each. L is silent in some letter groups.

Consonants · 2 letters

Ll The Letter L one sound

1 The sound of L

/l/
Tongue up behind your top teeth

lamp leg belt

2 When is L silent?

In ALK and ALF, L is silent.

ta**l**k wa**l**k ha**l**f

Grey letter = silent

USUALLY TRUE

In OULD, L is silent.

cou**l**d wou**l**d shou**l**d

ALWAYS

3 L with other letters

ll /l/ te**ll** wi**ll** he**ll**o — ALWAYS

le /əl/ tab**le** app**le** lit**tle**
At the end of a word. — ALWAYS

The Letters L and M (continued)

Mm The Letter M one sound

4 The sound of M

/m/
Close your lips and hum

milk mug drum

5 When is M silent?

M is almost never silent.

6 M with other letters

mb /m/ climb comb thumb

At the end of a word, the B is silent.

ALWAYS

mm /m/ summer hammer common

ALWAYS

Letters learned A B C D E F G H I J K L M **N** O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

Nn The Letter N

N is a consonant with one sound. With G and K it makes new sounds.

Consonant · 1 sound

1 The sound of N

/n/
Tongue up, air through your nose

net **nut** **fun**

2 When is N silent?

After M at the end of a word, N is silent.

autumn column

Grey letter = silent

● ALWAYS

The Letter N (continued)

3 N with other letters

ng	/ŋ/	long song ring	ALWAYS
nk	/ŋk/	bank pink drink	ALWAYS
kn	/n/	know knee knife At the start of a word, the K is silent.	ALWAYS
gn	/n/	sign design foreign The G is silent. But: signal · signature	USUALLY TRUE
nn	/n/	dinner sunny funny	ALWAYS